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Memorandum to the German Government

[Secret Memorandum of Subhas Chandra Bose, Berlin, the 9th April, 1941.—Ed.]

PLAN FOR COOPERATION BETWEEN THE AXIS POWERS AND INDIA

As in the World War of 1914-18, so also in the present war, Great Britain has been endeavouring to exploit India for her war purposes. Since the war begin, Great Britain has not relaxed her political and economic grip over India in spite of the manifold defeats she has suffered at the hands of Germany. To us in India, it is therefore crystal clear that as the British Empire collapses increasingly, Great Britain will try to hold on to India more and more and she will do so till the very last. It is also clear from British policy in India at the present time that if the British Empire somehow survives this war, Great Britain will endeavour to recover her strength by exploiting the rich resources of India so that she may be able to challenge the "New Order" after some years.

India is naturally interested in seeing Great Britain completely vanquished in this war and the British Empire completely broken up, so that India may attain her national independence. The British Empire constitutes the greatest obstacle not only in the path of India's freedom but also in the path of human progress.

Since the attitude of the Indian people is intensely hostile to the British in the present war, it is possible for them to materially assist in bringing about the overthrow of Great Britain. India's cooperation could be secured if the Indian people are assured that an Axis victory will mean for them a free India.

In order to establish full cooperation between the Axis Powers and India for the achievement of the common objectives of defeating Great Britain, the following plan is being proposed : It will